

181 BCE

SHUNGA DYNASTY ESTABLISHED

Pushyamitra Shunga (r. 185–149 BCE) – a general of the Maurya Empire – established control over northern India after the assassination of Brihadratha, the last Mauryan emperor.

▽ Shunga period carvings showing scenes from Buddha's life



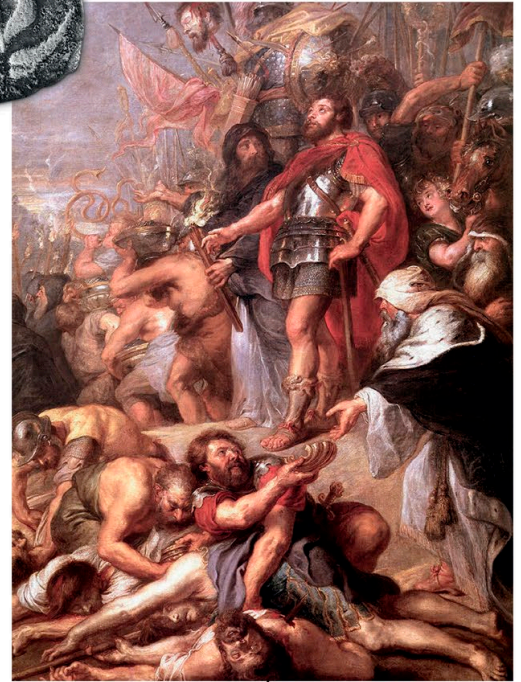
△ Hasmonean dynasty coin

165 BCE

JUDAS MACCABAEUS REVOLTS

After Seleucid ruler Antiochus IV outlawed Jewish practices in Judea and Samaria, Judas Maccabaeus and his brothers led a revolt, taking Jerusalem in 164 BCE. Judas purified the Temple, restored Jewish worship, and established the Hasmonaean dynasty, which ruled until overthrown by Herod the Great in 37 BCE.

▷ *Judas Maccabaeus Praying for the Dead*, 1635, by Peter Paul Rubens



200 BCE

**171–168 BCE The Romans
defeat Perseus of Macedon**
in the Third Macedonian War

c. 150 BCE

GREAT SERPENT MOUND IS BUILT

The Adena were a people of the eastern woodlands of North America. Living in villages of circular houses, they hunted deer and elk, gathered edible grasses, and farmed pumpkin and squash. They built hundreds of mounds, probably as funerary monuments, the most spectacular of which was the Great Serpent Mound in Ohio. It was fashioned in the shape of a serpent with sinuous coils.

